

IAS PRELIMS/MAINS

Ecology & Environment

A stylized illustration of a green city skyline with various skyscrapers, wind turbines, and a sun, set against a light green background with a globe-like shape.

A COMPREHENSIVE COVERAGE

MODULE - 7

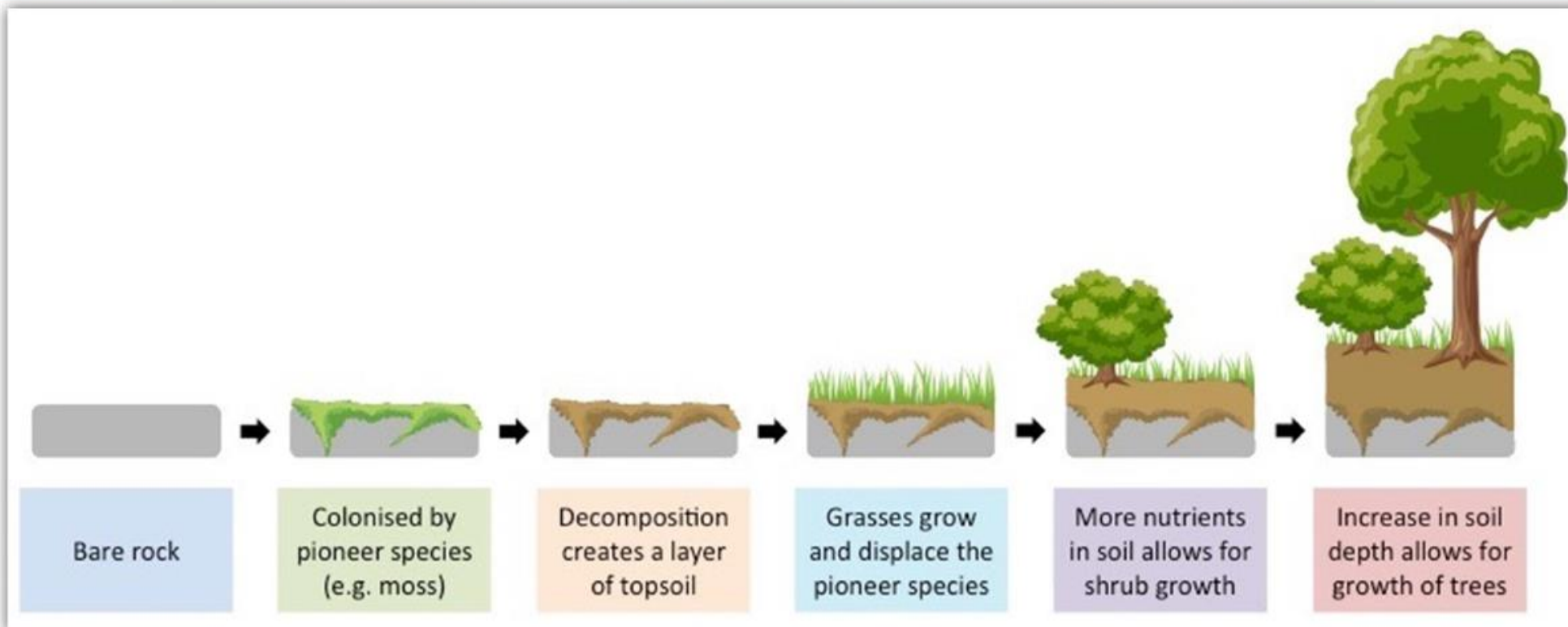
BASIC CONCEPTS - 7

ECOLOGICAL SUCCESSION

- The process by which species of plants and animals in an area are replaced by others over a period of time is known as Ecological Succession.
- Succession occurs when a series of communities replace one another due to large scale destruction (natural or manmade). This process continues with one community replacing another, until a stable, mature community develops.
- The terminal (final) stage of succession forms the community which is called as Climax Community. A climax community is stable, mature, more complex and long lasting.
- The first species to colonize an area is called the Pioneer Community. The final stage of succession is called the climax community. The stages leading to the climax community are called Successional stages or Seres.

PRIMARY SUCCESSION

Primary succession takes place on over a bare or unoccupied areas such as rocks, newly formed deltas, emerging volcano islands, glacial moraines (muddy area exposed by a retreating glacier) etc. where no community has existed previously.



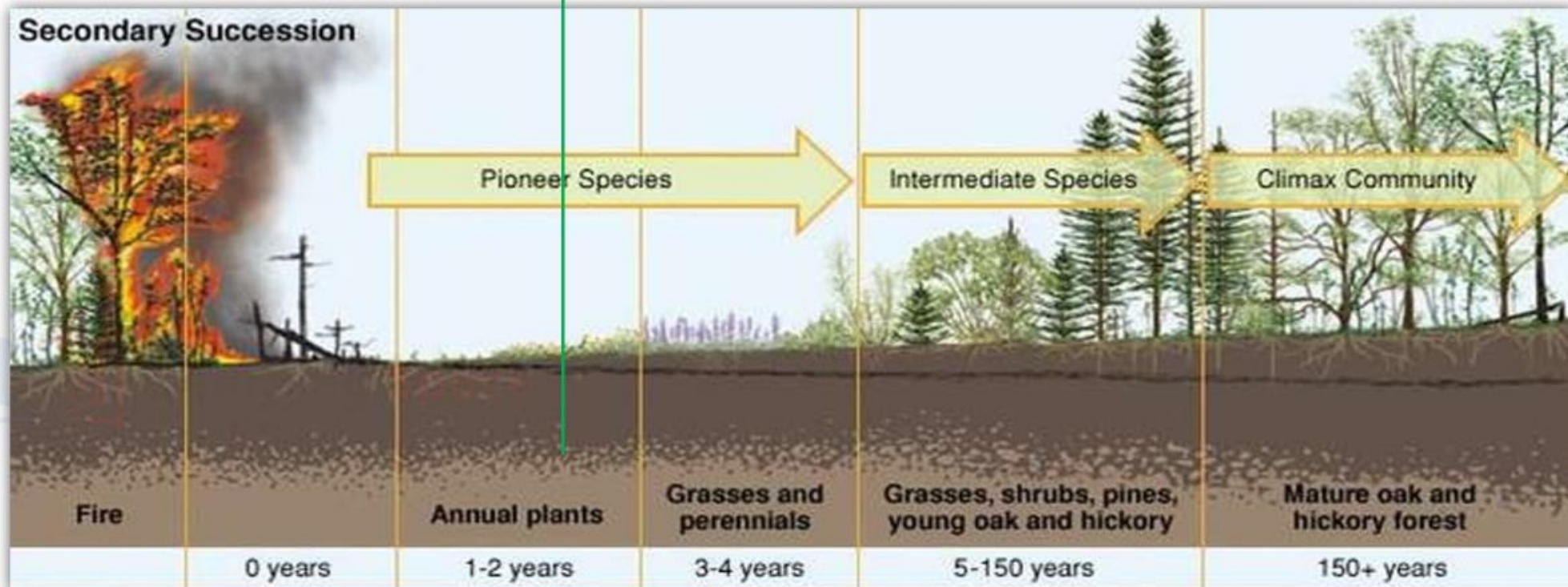
PRIMARY SUCCESSION

- In primary succession the new site is first colonized by a few hardy pioneer species that are often microbes, lichens and mosses.
- The pioneers over a few generations alter the habitat conditions by their growth and development. The new habitat conditions are suitable for the growth of other organisms. Eventually, the pioneer community gets replaced by the other species.



SECONDARY SUCCESSION

- Secondary succession occurs when plants colonize an area in which the climax community has been disturbed.
- Unlike in the primary succession, the secondary succession starts on a well-developed soil already formed at the site.
- Thus, secondary succession is relatively faster as compared to primary succession which may often require hundreds of years.



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